Infura is a cloudlike infrastructure that enables the Ethereum node as a service. It also facilitates linking with many public networks, such as the mainnet (using real ether), Ropsten, and Rinkeby (using test ether); and provides a gateway for IPFS, a decentralized file system. It offers an easy-to-use dashboard for creating Ethereum projects for deploying smart contracts, configuring security settings for projects, and selecting the public network to connect to.

Figure 8.4 shows Infura's dashboard for creating projects. After you sign up on Infura, you should be able to log in and open the dashboard by clicking Dashboard and then clicking the Ethereum symbol in the left panel. You are allowed up to three projects (in the free version), and you can name them appropriately. In the dashboard, click Create New Project.

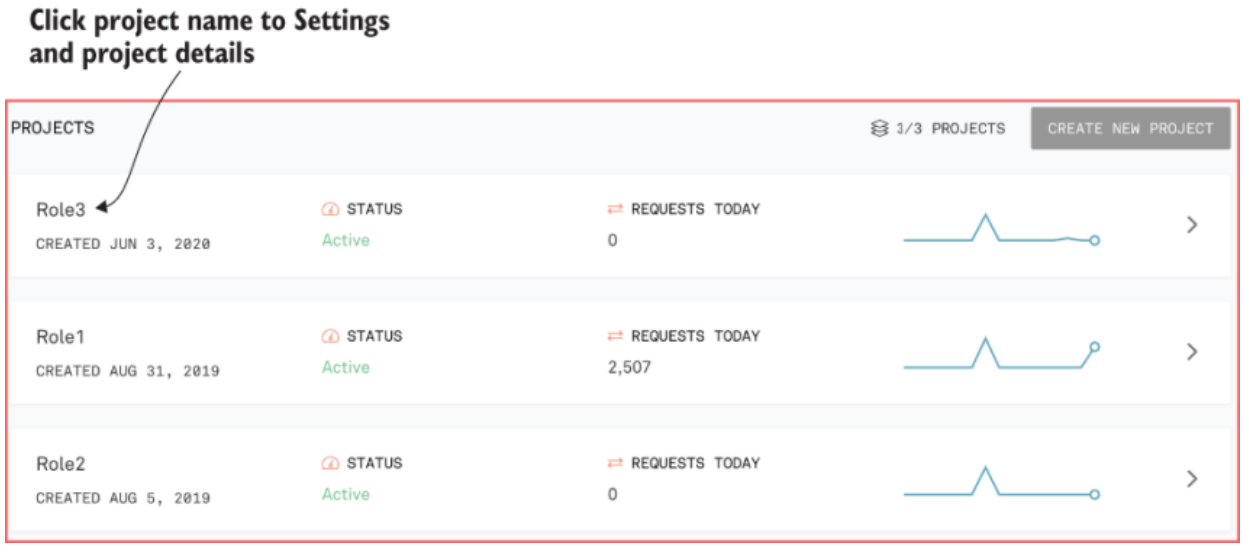


Figure 8.4 Infura dashboard for project creation

The creation of a project involves naming the project and optionally configuring its security setting with a password.